IDFC FIRST Bank

ALWAYS YOU FIRST



India's Pride: ***Amitabh Bachchan***

When the foundation is strong, you can build a great bank for the ages

IDFC FIRST Bank was created by the merger of IDFC Bank and Capital First in early 2019, and we were an early stage bank. Our Bank, though highly respected, was not very well known at that stage. In one of our discussions, we came up with the idea of signing up the iconic Mr. Bachchan. Someone suggested we use the ad agency to contact him or his manager. Almost by instinct, I remarked, "Forget agents and agencies, let us just go across to his place and meet him".

The same evening, we were sitting in his beautifully decorated office at around 8 pm. Believe it or not, we hit it off straightaway and the warmth was instinctive. Within a fortnight, we had closed the contract and Mr. Bachchan was our brand ambassador! There was no agent, no intermediary - it was all simply straight and a hop across to his office.



To be as exceptionally talented in the early 20s, someone who can sing, dance and be naturally gifted in terms of physique, voice, diction, and persona, is an extraordinary God-gifted combination. That he reached the heights he did is not a surprise. But what struck me was his simplicity and humility despite his extraordinary successes. For example, the second time I met him for discussions, he had come down the stairs to see me off to my car which was in itself a gesture. But even more, my driver who had ferried me to his house asked me if he could get a picture with him. You will be surprised to know that he readily put his arm around my personal driver and gave him a picture. And all this when we had not even signed him up and were in exploratory discussions. That tells you something about him.

We all know Mr Bachchan as an iconic personality of our times. His performance as an action hero in movies like Zanzeer, Sholay, Deewaar, Yaarana, Laawaris or in sensitive roles such as Anand and Silsila, or Baghbaan are for the ages. Over the years he has reinvented himself again and again into more new generation movies like Paa, has been a television host of the popular show Kaun Banega Crorepati and so on. What is more amazing is that through all this evolution, during his extraordinary 60 years of public life, he has conducted himself with extreme grace all through, and has been an inspiration to one and all. He is a well-deserved recipient of the Padma Shri, Padma Bhushan and Padma Vibhushan awards.



He visited our office for the sign-up ceremony where employees cheered and screamed with excitement. After the ceremony, some of us gathered in our Board room and exchanged pleasantries and concluded the signing ceremony. Later at our offices, he spoke to our employees, who greeted him with applause. Amazingly, he was exceptionally well prepared, had done a pre-read about the Bank and could relate anecdotes and interesting points about us; the high point was when he ended his speech with 'Always You First', our brand's tagline. And with no briefing from any of us!